

Minar Pimple

Minar Pimple is the Founder of MP Consulting and the founder of YUVA (Youth for Unity and Voluntary Action), which he led as CEO from 1984 to 2004. Working on poverty and exclusion in India since 1977, he has spent four decades across civil society, the UN system and global institutions, and now coaches and advises senior leaders in the social sector.

Education

- Master's degree in Social Work, University of Bombay (now University of Mumbai)
- Visiting Moynihan Fellow on transnational NGOs, Syracuse University

Career

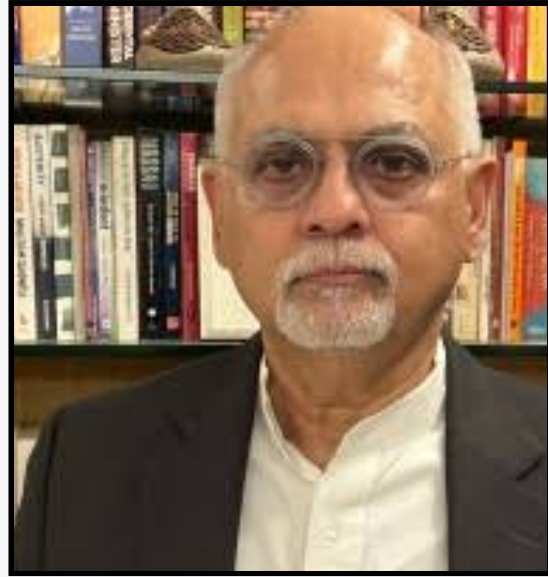
Founded YUVA in 1984 as a youth-led organisation and led it for two decades, building it into an ecosystem of institutions (YUVA Urban, YUVA Rural, YUVA Consulting and YUVA Centre) working on human rights and sustainable development for the urban and rural poor.

Was Founder Chair of Oxfam India, leading the merger of seven Oxfams into a single Indian organisation. Went on to lead the People's Movement for Human Rights Learning (PDHRE) in New York and the Human Rights Cities programme at UNDP, and served as Regional Director for Asia-Pacific of the UN Millennium Campaign in Bangkok.

As Senior Director, Global Operations at Amnesty International, led its "Moving Closer to the Ground" transition, rolling out 15 regional offices worldwide. Later drove organisational transformation at a major international philanthropy before founding MP Consulting.

Global Roles and Boards

- Board roles with Oxfam International and Habitat International Coalition
- Speaker at the Civil Society Development Forum in Geneva, the UCLG conference on the MDGs in Rome, and side events to the UN High-Level Event on the MDGs
- Expert on poverty reduction, governance and accountability, with a focus on human rights, sustainable development and land rights
- Has written for the World Economic Forum
- Long record of campaigning and advocacy for basic services, including education, health and sustainable livelihoods, at local, national and international levels



Minar Pimple's Story

Since his youth, Minar has focused on the consequences of caste discrimination, marginalisation and exclusion in India. He saw a role for young people in shaping how their city was planned, and formed YUVA in 1984 to give them that voice. Its early mobilisation drew on singing, street theatre and video films for public education, a style that became part of YUVA's culture. Alongside national coalition-building, YUVA built international alliances, recognising that struggles over housing and informal labour rights are not limited to India.

Leadership Across Institutions

Minar's career has been defined by large-scale institutional change: growing YUVA from a single organisation into an ecosystem, merging seven Oxfams into one, and restructuring Amnesty International's global presence.

Through MP Consulting, he takes a networked, bespoke approach to coaching senior leaders across the not-for-profit sector. He sees social sector leadership as balancing challenge with empathy, knowing when leaders should step aside, and building second-line leadership so institutions don't depend on one person. He argues that context, including culture, class, gender and geography, shapes what kind of leadership a moment demands.

He is candid about the widening gap between funding needs and shrinking civic space, including FCRA pressures on Indian organisations. He argues that legitimacy must be earned with communities, not just with donors.

His reflections return to one theme: building leaders rather than dependencies, so that institutions endure beyond the people who start them.